

THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of the NSC Deputies Committee

DATE: May 9, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 1:15 p.m. - 3:00 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Deputies Committee Meeting on
Bosnia and Croatia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

Chair:
Samuel R. Berger

OVP:
William Wise

State:
Peter Tarnoff
Robert Frasure
Chris Hill

DOD:
Walter Slocombe
James Pardew

OMB:
Gordon Adams
John Burnim

USUN:
Madeleine Albright
Rick Inderfurth
David Scheffer

CIA:
Douglas MacEachin
Norm Schindler

JCS:
ADM William Owens
LTG Wesley Clark

NSC:
Alexander Vershbow
BG Don Kerrick
Steven Simon

Summary of Conclusions

1. Deputies met to discuss next steps in dealing with the Contact Group on what degree of sanctions relief to offer Milosevic in return for genuine recognition of Bosnia. Following Ambassador Frasure's report on his two meetings with Milosevic, Deputies discussed a State proposal for a new, two-pronged approach that incorporates sanctions relief and new OSCE involvement. Deputies directed that a paper outlining the new proposal be circulated to the Deputies by May 10 for subsequent Principals consideration. **(Action: State)** Deputies reemphasized the need to work in close coordination with the Bosnian Government on any proposal regarding its goal of gaining

genuine recognition by Milosevic of Bosnia-Herzegovina within its internationally recognized borders in return for limited sanctions relief and a closure of the border with Bosnian Serb territory. ~~(S)~~

2. Deputies reviewed the situation in Croatia and progress on preventing escalation following the Vice President's meeting with President Tudjman in London over the weekend. Deputies agreed that the situation remained very volatile and that the U.S. should continue to press President Tudjman to exercise restraint. They agreed that Ambassador Holbrooke should follow-up with Tudjman on his agreement with the Vice President to accept some UNCRO presence in Sector West and to refrain from military action in other areas of conflict. Deputies further directed that Ambassador Albright and Ambassador Galbraith continue efforts with appropriate Croatian authorities to develop positions that will further defuse the situation. (Action: State/USUN) ~~(S)~~

4. Deputies discussed options for dealing with the situation in Sarajevo where increased violations of the exclusion zone and the Bosnian Serb closure of the Sarajevo airport continue to erode UN authority and NATO credibility. Deputies agreed that the untenable situation, and lack of UN will to fully execute its mandate, places the continuation of UNPROFOR in Bosnia at serious risk. Noting that with the change in Government, the French will undertake a review of their participation in UNPROFOR, Deputies directed that a strategy be developed for gaining French support for tougher UN action in Sarajevo. (Action: State) Deputies further directed that the JCS Sarajevo military options paper be circulated to Principals. (Action: JCS) ~~(S)~~

5. Deputies briefly discussed the IWG efforts in developing a post-UNPROFOR withdrawal strategy and in drafting answers to the unanswered policy questions regarding OPLAN 40104. Noting that more time was needed to review the work, Deputies asked that Agency comments be promptly provided (NLT COB May 11) directly to State (EUR). State will incorporate comments and circulate another version for Deputies final review on Friday, May 12. (Action: State) A subsequent version which incorporates any additional Deputies' comments will be circulated to Principals. ~~(S)~~

6. Deputies discussed the SACEUR's request for authority to issue an ACTREQ for the enabling and main forces in OPLAN 40104 that may be forwarded to the North Atlantic Council (NAC) next week. Deputies agreed that this request goes beyond existing Principals' authorization and directed that the following actions be taken to frame the issue for Principals' decision:

- o Present Principals with proposed answers to OPLAN 40104 unanswered policy questions NLT Monday, May 15. (Action: State) ~~(S)~~

- o Clarify the significance of the ACTREQ as it relates to the overall OPLAN 40104 approval process. (Action: OSD/JCS)
~~(S)~~
- o Gauge likely NATO response to the request and develop appropriate guidance to U.S. representatives at NATO. (Action: State/DoD) ~~(S)~~
- o Prepare ACTREQ options/decision paper for Principals' consideration NLT Monday, May 15. (Action: DoD with State input) ~~(S)~~
- o Defer Congressional briefings until questions concerning new authorities requested by the SACEUR are clarified. (Action: NSC/IWG) ~~(S)~~

Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

This is not a presidential record. This is used as an administrative marker by the William J. Clinton Presidential Library Staff.

Documents from this Mandatory Declassification Review were released in full or released in part.

Those documents released with redactions have been restricted under Section 1.4 (c) of E.O. 13526 and (b)(3) of the FOIA.
